ESTABLISHED 1879
Crescent City
California

The Triplicate

TODAY: Morning fog, 59°
TONIGHT: Clearing, 48°
Full almanac — Page A12

Serving California's North Coast and Del Norte County since 1879

VOL. 147 • NO. 21 CRESCENT CITY, CALIFORNIA • WEDNESDAY, MAY 27, 2026 • NORTH COAST EDITION $1.50

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ON THE COAST

Marine layer through midmorning, then high overcast. West wind 10–15 mph by afternoon.

	High	Low
Today	59°	48°
Thu	61°	49°
Fri	60°	47°
Sat	63°	50°

Tides and sun tables, A12.

ALSO INSIDE

Crab season tally

Del Norte boats land their best Dungeness haul in four years. — A6

Warriors advance

Del Norte High baseball takes the league semifinal in extra innings. — A8

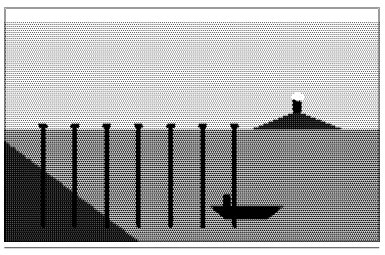
Redwoods reopen

Howland Hill Road grading wraps ahead of the holiday weekend. — A4

WATERFRONT

Harbor breaks ground on tsunami-resilient docks

Forty years after the wave that defined the town, Crescent City begins a $29 million rebuild engineered to ride out the next one.



Pilings for the new inner-boat-basin float system are set near Citizens Dock on Tuesday morning, with the Battery Point light visible beyond the breakwater. / **Triplicate / J. Okafor**

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

Under a sky that could not decide between fog and sun, a line of pile drivers went to work in the inner boat basin on Tuesday, driving the first of 214 steel-cased pilings for a harbor that has been knocked flat more times than any other on the West Coast.

The $29 million project — funded through a braid of federal hazard-mitigation grants, a state coastal-resilience bond and the harbor district's own reserves — will replace timber floats first laid down after the 1964 tsunami and patched again after the 2011 surge that arrived from Japan. This time, engineers say, the docks are built to move with the water rather than against it.

Designed to flex

"The old docks were rigid, and rigid things break," said Harbor District Director Lourdes Avila, standing where the gangway will land. "These floats ride up the pilings on collars. A six-foot surge lifts them six feet and sets them back down. That is the whole idea."

The design borrows from harbors in Hilo and Kushiro that have absorbed repeated tsunamis. Sacrificial breakaway sections are meant to fail in a predictable order, sparing the main basin and the commercial fleet that is the economic spine of the county.

> "The old docks were rigid, and rigid things break. These ride up the pilings and set back down."
>
> **— Lourdes Avila, Harbor District director**

For the crab and salmon fleet, the work cannot finish soon enough. Skippers have spent two decades tying up to floats that list and groan in a hard swell. "You learn which cleats to trust," said Dom Pereira, who has fished out of Crescent City since 1991. "After this, maybe I trust all of them."

Construction will proceed in three phases through the winter, with the commercial basin kept open throughout. The district expects the recreational floats and a rebuilt public pier — with interpretive panels on the town's tsunami history — to open by next Memorial Day.

Mayor Priya Sandoval, who watched the first piling go down, framed the morning in plain terms. "We do not get to choose whether the ocean comes for this harbor again," she said. "We only get to choose what it finds when it does."

Continued on Page A4, Column 1

COUNTY

Supervisors clear path for county-wide broadband

A 1,400-mile fiber plan would reach Klamath, Gasquet and Smith River by 2029.

By Theo Brennan · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Del Norte County Board of Supervisors voted 4–1 on Tuesday to accept a $61 million state middle-mile grant, committing the county to a fiber-optic backbone that planners say would finally close the broadband gap that has shadowed the North Coast for a generation.

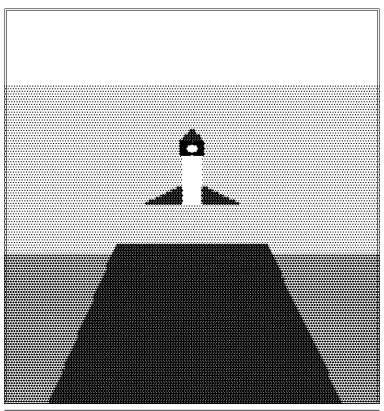
The network would follow the Highway 101 and 199 corridors, with spurs to the Yurok and Tolowa Dee-ni' communities along the lower Klamath. Supervisor Gail Whitethorn, the lone dissenting vote, said she supported the goal but wanted firmer guarantees that rural addresses — not just town centers — would see service.

"I have constituents in Gasquet who file their taxes from the library parking lot," Whitethorn said. "I need to know the line actually turns up their road."

County Administrative Officer Renée Castellano said construction bids would go out this fall, with the first homes connected in late 2027 and full buildout targeted for 2029.

HERITAGE

Battery Point light marks 170 years on the rock



The 1856 Battery Point Lighthouse, reachable on foot only at low tide. / **Triplicate file**

By Iris Lindqvist · Triplicate Staff Writer

When the lamp at Battery Point was first lit on the night of Dec. 10, 1856, Crescent City was a muddy supply landing for the Klamath gold camps. The light has outlasted the camps, two tsunamis and the lumber boom that built and then emptied the surrounding blocks.

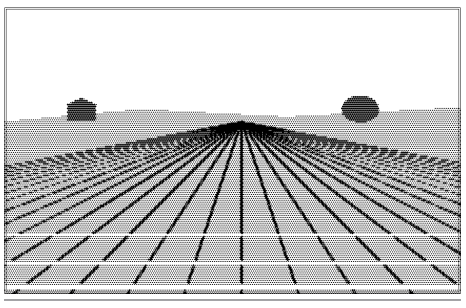
The Del Norte County Historical Society will mark the anniversary Saturday with low-tide tours, a keeper's-log reading and chowder on the lawn. Volunteers note the island is cut off when the tide comes in — visitors who linger get a free, unscheduled overnight.

"It is the most photographed thing in the county and the least convenient to reach," said society president Walt Hennessey. "That is precisely why people love it."

SMITH RIVER

Easter lily growers bet the farm on a warming bloom

Ninety percent of the nation's potted Easter lilies come from a ten-mile strip of coast. A shifting climate is rewriting the planting calendar.



Furrowed bulb fields run toward the morning fog north of Smith River, where the maritime climate has supported Easter-lily culture since the 1940s. / **Triplicate / J. Okafor**

By Theo Brennan · Triplicate Staff Writer

SMITH RIVER — In the bulb fields that run from the Smith River bottoms to the Oregon line, a dozen families grow nearly every Easter lily sold in North America. It is a crop measured in years, not seasons: a marketable bulb takes three to four years of digging, sorting and replanting before it is forced into a single, perfectly timed bloom.

That timing is the whole business, and it is getting harder. Growers say warmer, drier springs are pulling the bloom forward, threatening the delicate choreography that has to land a flowering plant on a store shelf the week before Easter — a date that itself wanders across five weeks of the calendar.

"We are farming a holiday," said grower Anna Sefton, whose family has worked the same ground since 1948. "The lily does not care what the church calendar says. We have to make it care."

The cooperative that markets the bulbs has begun staggering plantings across more microclimates and investing in cold-storage that can hold bloom back by days. The adjustments are expensive for a crop with thin margins and a single, unforgiving sell-by date.

Still, the growers are not going anywhere. The same fog that frustrates the lighthouse keepers two ridges west is exactly what the lily wants — cool nights, gray mornings, and a soil that drains the North Coast rain.

AROUND DEL NORTE

Klamath

The Yurok Tribe's salmon-counting weir went in below Blue Creek this week, the first full season since the Klamath dams came down. Biologists report early Chinook moving past the old reservoir reaches.

Gasquet

The Middle Fork Ranger Station reopens for the summer Saturday. Wilderness permits for the Siskiyou high country are available at the counter.

Fort Dick

A power pole struck by a log truck knocked out service to 600 customers Monday evening. Crews restored power before midnight.

Hiouchi

The Smith River visitor center reopens daily for the season Friday, with a new exhibit on the 2024 dam removals downstream on the Klamath.

Crescent City

A leaking fire hydrant on Cooper Avenue will be replaced Thursday; the 400 block loses water service from 9 a.m. to noon.

HOWONQUET

Tolowa Dee-ni' Nation breaks ground on language center

By Iris Lindqvist · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Tolowa Dee-ni' Nation broke ground Saturday on a $4.2 million language and culture center at Howonquet, the latest step in a decades-long effort to bring the Tolowa language back into daily use after it was nearly silenced by a century of boarding-school policy.

The center will house immersion classrooms, a recording studio for elder speakers and a workshop for canoe carving and basketry. "A language lives in the mouths of children or it does not live," said tribal chairperson Della Richmond. "This building is where it gets to live."

Construction is expected to finish by spring 2027. The Nation is recruiting apprentice speakers now.

DOWNTOWN

Crescent City revives summer farmers market

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

After two fallow summers, the downtown farmers market returns to the harbor-side lot on Saturday mornings beginning in June, with a roster of growers, a fish-off-the-boat vendor and live music from the high-school jazz band.

Organizers credit a small business grant and a new volunteer board. "People want a reason to be downtown on a Saturday," said coordinator Beth Onganga. "Tomatoes are a pretty good reason."

LAKE EARL

Volunteers clear winter's blowdown from Tolowa Dunes trails

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

A weekend work party of two dozen volunteers cleared more than a mile of storm-fallen alder and spruce from the Tolowa Dunes and Lake Earl trails, reopening the loop to Kellogg Beach in time for the summer season.

State Parks supplied the saws; the Friends of Del Norte supplied the muscle and the lunch. "Every winter the wind rearranges the place," said crew leader Will Abernathy. "Every spring we put the trails back. It is a fair trade for living here."

The next work party, focused on dune-grass restoration, is set for the second Saturday in June.

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CITY COUNCIL

Council adopts budget that spares the library, trims overtime

A $48.6 million spending plan closes a projected shortfall without layoffs, but leaves three police positions unfilled.

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Crescent City Council adopted a $48.6 million budget for the coming fiscal year Monday night, closing a projected $1.9 million shortfall through a freeze on hiring, a reduction in overtime and a one-time draw on reserves — and, in the end, sparing the public library hours that had been on the chopping block since March.

The 4–1 vote came after three hours of public comment dominated by library supporters, who packed the chambers and the overflow lobby. "You do not balance a budget on the backs of the kids who use the only quiet, free, warm room in town," said resident Carla Devereaux, drawing applause the mayor had to gavel down.

City Manager Frank Ostrowski said the freeze leaves three police positions and two public-works jobs unfilled, and warned that the reserve draw is not repeatable. "This budget works once," he said. "Next year we need either growth or cuts. There is no third door."

Councilmember Lena Marsh cast the lone no vote, arguing the city should have used the reserves to keep the police positions instead. "Response times are the budget line residents actually feel," she said.

The budget takes effect July 1. A mid-year review is scheduled for January.

PUBLIC NOTICES

Planning Commission — June 3, 6 p.m., City Hall. Use permit for a 14-unit infill project on H Street; coastal development permit for a harbor-side café.

Harbor District — June 5, 5 p.m. Dock reconstruction phase-one update; slip-fee schedule.

School Board — June 9, 6:30 p.m. 2026–27 calendar; bond oversight report.

Full agendas at the City Clerk's office and online.

COUNTY

Supervisors back broadband, defer cannabis rules

By Theo Brennan · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Board of Supervisors accepted the state's middle-mile broadband grant Tuesday (see Page A1) and, in a quieter vote, postponed a contested overhaul of the county's cannabis cultivation ordinance for the third time this year.

Supervisor Gail Whitethorn asked staff to return in August with a version that separates licensing for small legacy growers from rules aimed at larger operations. "We keep trying to write one rule for two very different things," she said.

The deferral leaves the current moratorium on new permits in place through the summer.

PUBLIC SAFETY

Sheriff seeks funds for second marine patrol boat

By Theo Brennan · Triplicate Staff Writer

Sheriff Marcus Bell told supervisors his office needs a second patrol vessel to cover the harbor, the Klamath estuary and 37 miles of rugged coast with a single aging boat.

"When that one boat is in for repair, we have no water coverage at all," Bell said. The board directed staff to look for grant matches before the fall budget cycle.

CALTRANS

Roadwork on U.S. 101 to bring summer delays

Caltrans will repave a six-mile stretch of U.S. 101 south of town beginning in July, with one-way controlled traffic on weekdays. Crews will work nights through the harbor district to limit daytime backups, the agency said.

CIVIL GRAND JURY

Grand jury faults county on deferred jail maintenance

By Theo Brennan · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Del Norte County civil grand jury, in its annual report released Monday, found that years of deferred maintenance at the county jail have left two housing units operating below capacity and recommended the board set aside dedicated repair funding in each year's budget.

The report praised the sheriff's medical staff but warned that the building's aging plumbing and a failing boiler pose a growing risk. "Maintenance deferred is maintenance multiplied," the foreperson wrote.

By law the board and the sheriff must respond to each finding within 90 days. Sheriff Marcus Bell said he agreed with "essentially all of it" and had been making the same case at budget time for years.

ELECTIONS

Harbor bond measure headed for November ballot

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Harbor District board voted Tuesday to place a $12 million general-obligation bond before voters in November, the local match that would unlock the remaining state and federal money for the dock reconstruction now under way.

If approved by the required two-thirds, the measure would add an estimated $19 a year per $100,000 of assessed value. Opponents have not yet organized; supporters say the alternative is a half-finished harbor.

The county elections office must receive final ballot language by August 8.

COUNTY BRIEFS

Assessor

Property-tax statements mail next week; the assessor's office extends counter hours through June.

Public Works

The Elk Valley culvert replacement closes one lane of Northcrest Drive weekdays through July.

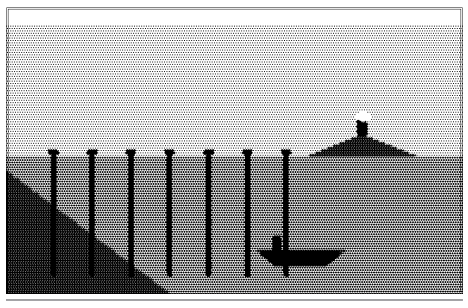
Clerk-Recorder

Passport appointments are again available Fridays; bring two forms of ID.

FROM PAGE A1 · THE HARBOR

Engineering a harbor to survive the wave

The science of riding out a tsunami, and why Crescent City is the place the country comes to learn it.



The inner boat basin, where breakaway float sections are designed to fail in sequence and spare the commercial fleet. **/ Triplicate / J. Okafor**

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

Continued from Page A1. Crescent City sits at the receiving end of a quirk of bathymetry. The continental shelf and the curve of the coast funnel Pacific tsunami energy straight into the harbor mouth, then trap and amplify it. That is why a 1964 wave generated off Alaska — which spared most of the West Coast — killed eleven people here and erased the downtown.

It is also why the harbor has become an outdoor laboratory. Researchers from three universities maintain instruments on the breakwater, and the new dock design is being watched as a national test case for resilient marine infrastructure.

Move with the water

The core idea is counterintuitive: do not fight the surge, float on it. The new floats ride collars up the steel pilings, rising with the water and settling back as it drains. Sacrificial links are tuned to part in a known order so a failure stays local.

"Every harbor on this coast is going to need this eventually," said coastal engineer Priya Nandakumar, who consulted on the design. "Crescent City just has the least patience for waiting, because it has the most experience with what waiting costs."

The interpretive panels planned for the rebuilt pier will, for the first time, put that history in front of the tourists who stop for crab rolls — a small civic insistence that the town's defining trauma also be its standing lesson.

IF A TSUNAMI WARNING SOUNDS

Know your zone. If you are in the inundation zone (harbor district, lowlands south of Front Street), move to high ground immediately — do not wait for an official order.

On foot is faster. Roads jam. High ground is minutes away uphill.

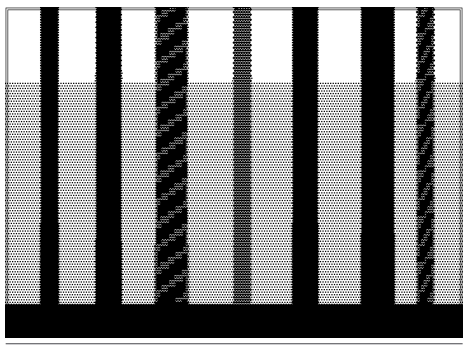
A strong quake IS the warning. If you cannot stand, do not wait for sirens. Go.

Stay up. Waves arrive in a train for hours. The first is rarely the largest.

Zone maps: Office of Emergency Services, and Page A12.

JEDEDIAH SMITH

Howland Hill grading reopens redwood byway



Old growth along Howland Hill Road. **/ Triplicate file**

By Iris Lindqvist · Triplicate Staff Writer

State Parks crews finished grading the unpaved Howland Hill Road this week, reopening the narrow corridor through Jedediah Smith Redwoods State Park ahead of the holiday weekend. The road threads between trees older than the nation and is closed each winter to washouts.

Rangers remind drivers the route is one lane in places, with no cell service and a 15-mph reality regardless of the posted limit. "It is not a shortcut," said ranger Eli Sato. "It is the destination."

WATERSHED

Smith River runs clear as restoration takes hold

By Theo Brennan · Triplicate Staff Writer

Water-quality monitors on the Smith — the last major undammed river in California — report another year of exceptional clarity, a baseline that researchers increasingly use to measure what other recovering rivers might become.

Volunteers with the watershed council will host a citizen-science clarity day on the South Fork next month.

EDITORIAL

Build the docks, and tell the whole story

The harbor rebuild is an act of faith. So is teaching every visitor why it was needed.

There is a temptation, whenever Crescent City rebuilds its waterfront, to rebuild quietly — to pour the concrete, cut the ribbon and let the tourists assume the calm water was always calm. We hope the harbor district resists it.

The $29 million dock project that began this week is the right kind of ambitious. It does not pretend the ocean can be kept out. It plans, instead, for the ocean to come in, and to leave the working fleet intact when it does. That is maturity cast in steel.

But the most important line item may be the cheapest: the interpretive panels on the new public pier. A town that has buried its dead from two tsunamis owes its visitors more than a crab roll and a postcard. It owes them the truth that the postcard sits in an inundation zone.

Tell the whole story. The docks will protect the boats. The story protects the people.

— The Triplicate Editorial Board

THE TRIPLICATE

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Eleanor R. Maddox, Publisher
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Priya Venkatesh, Managing Editor
Walt Hennessey, Opinion Editor
Maren Holloway · Theo Brennan · Iris Lindqvist, Staff Writers
312 H Street, Crescent City, CA 95531
Letters: letters@triplicate.example
Signed columns reflect the author. Editorials reflect the board.

Letters to the Editor

Keep the library open later, not shorter

I read that the council saved the library hours. Good. Now go further. The students who ride two buses from Smith River need the building open until eight, not closed at five. A library that closes when the work starts is a reading room, not a library.

— Daniel Osei, Crescent City

Slow down on Howland Hill

To the tourist who passed me on a blind curve under the big trees Saturday: the road is older than your hurry. So are the redwoods. Please drive like a guest.

— Marjorie Pell, Hiouchi

Thank the lily growers

Before you buy a grocery-store Easter lily next spring, know it likely grew ten miles up the coast in our fog. We export beauty. Let us be proud of it.

— Ron Whitcombe, Smith River

The harbor money is well spent

Some will grumble at $29 million for docks. I fished forty years off those floats and watched two of them get torn out by water. Build them right once. The grumbling will pass; the next wave will not negotiate.

— Dom Pereira, Crescent City

Remember the eleven

As we celebrate the new harbor, let us not forget the eleven neighbors who died in 1964. Put their names on the new pier, not just the engineering. A town remembers, or it learns nothing.

— Sister Agnes Moloney, Crescent City

Slow the trucks downtown

Log trucks still take H Street too fast for a street with a school crossing. One painted line is not a plan. Please, council, before someone is hurt.

— Bonnie Achterberg, Crescent City

COLUMN · WALT HENNESSEY

A working coast keeps its receipts

My grandfather kept the Battery Point light for nineteen years and never once called the fog an inconvenience. The fog, he said, was the rent we pay for a coast worth living on.

I think about that every time someone proposes to make this town into something it is not — a resort, a bedroom community, a brand. We are a working coast. The boats leave before dawn and come back smelling of diesel and crab. The trees are a business and a cathedral at once.

The new docks are a receipt. They say: we intend to keep working here, and we have done the arithmetic on what that costs. I find that more romantic than any postcard.

There is a particular dignity in a town that does not pretend. We do not pretend the fog will lift for the tourists. We do not pretend the ocean is tame. We get up before it does, and we go to work, and we keep our receipts. The lighthouse my grandfather tended is automated now, but the principle has not changed: somebody has to keep the light, and somebody has to mind the water, and in this town that somebody is us.

SOUND OFF — QUESTION OF THE WEEK

Should the new public pier carry the names of the 1964 victims?
Vote at triplicate.example/soundoff or drop a card at 312 H Street. Results and selected comments print next Wednesday.
Last week: 81% said the library hours were worth saving.

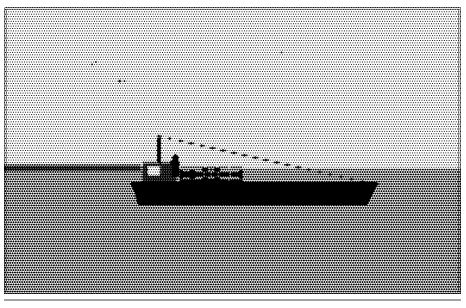
TODAY IN HISTORY

1854 — The schooner *Pomona* lands the first sawmill machinery at Crescent City.
1856 — Construction begins on the Battery Point Lighthouse.
1964 — A tsunami from the Good Friday earthquake strikes the harbor.
2011 — Surge from the Tōhoku earthquake again damages the docks.

DUNGENESS

Crab fleet lands its best season in four years

A late opening and strong prices put the Del Norte fleet back in the black after a string of lean winters.



The F/V Marie Elise runs for the inner basin stacked with pots at the close of a Dungeness season that landed 4.2 million pounds across the Citizens Dock hoist. / **Triplicate / J. Okafor**

By Theo Brennan · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Dungeness crab season that closed this month was the most lucrative for the Crescent City fleet in four years, with landings up 38 percent over last winter and a dock price that held above six dollars a pound deep into spring.

The season opened late again — delayed into December by elevated domoic-acid readings and the annual standoff over price — but once the boats went out, the crab were there. "Big, clean, and close in," said skipper Dom Pereira. "We did not have to steam to Oregon to find them this year."

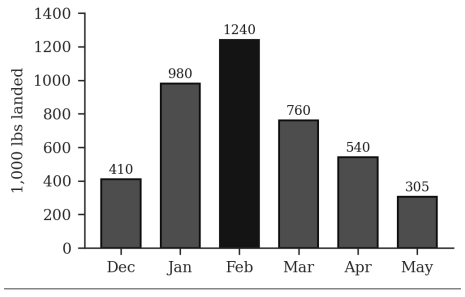
Harbor District figures show 4.2 million pounds crossed the Citizens Dock hoist, the bulk of it in a ferocious February. The catch supports not just the boats but the ice house, the processors and a seasonal payroll that ripples through every café on Front Street.

Scientists caution that warm-water years and shifting acid risk make the fishery less predictable than the good numbers suggest. "One strong season is a paycheck, not a trend," said state fishery biologist Ana Ruiz.

FISH MARKET — DOCK PRICES

Species	Per lb	Trend
Dungeness crab	$6.25	☐
Chinook salmon	$9.80	☐
Rockfish	$3.40	—
Lingcod	$4.10	☐
Pacific halibut	$11.50	☐
Albacore (frozen)	$3.95	—

Ex-vessel prices, week ending May 23. Source: Harbor District.



Monthly Dungeness landings at Crescent City Harbor, in thousands of pounds. February's peak was the strongest single month since 2022. / **Triplicate / Harbor District data**

DOWNTOWN

Front Street storefronts fill as season turns

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

Three long-empty storefronts on Front Street have new tenants this spring: a bakery, an outdoor-gear consignment shop and a second location for the Klamath coffee roaster. Brokers credit cheaper rents and the harbor project's promise of summer foot traffic.

"People follow construction cranes," said commercial agent Lou Tran. "They signal somebody believes in the block."

VISITORS

Tourism bureau pins summer on the redwoods, not the weather

By Iris Lindqvist · Triplicate Staff Writer

The county visitors bureau launched a summer campaign this week built around the redwood parks and the Smith River rather than the famously unreliable beach weather. "We stopped apologizing for the fog," said director Hana Brooks. "The fog is why the biggest trees on earth grow here. That is the pitch."

Lodging-tax receipts, a proxy for visitation, rose 6 percent over last year.

BUSINESS BRIEFS

Credit union opens a Smith River branch June 16.

Mill site cleanup grant clears final state review.

Airport adds a third weekly flight to Oakland for summer.

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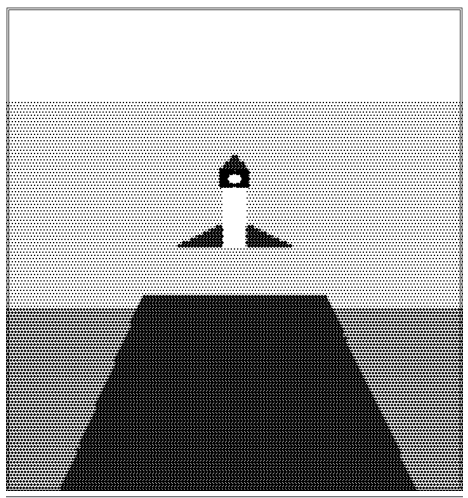
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HERITAGE

Battery Point light keeps its 170-year vigil

Volunteers will mark the anniversary with low-tide tours, a keeper's-log reading and chowder on the lawn.



The Battery Point Lighthouse, lit in 1856 and reachable on foot only at low tide, remains the most photographed landmark on the North Coast. / Triplicate / J. Okafor

By Iris Lindqvist · Triplicate Staff Writer

When the lamp at Battery Point was first lit on the night of Dec. 10, 1856, Crescent City was a muddy supply landing for the Klamath gold camps. The light has outlasted the camps, the lumber boom, two tsunamis and a dozen schemes to make the town into something other than itself.

On Saturday the Del Norte County Historical Society will mark 170 years of that vigil with tours timed to the tide, a public reading from the keepers' logs, and chowder served on the island lawn — weather, as ever, permitting.

"It is the most photographed thing in the county and the least convenient to reach," said society president Walt Hennessey. "The island cuts off when the tide comes in. Visitors who linger get a free, unscheduled overnight, same as the keepers did."

The logs themselves are the draw. Generations of keepers recorded shipwrecks, whale strandings, the night the 1964 wave came over the causeway, and an unbroken century of weather that reads, in aggregate, like the autobiography of the coast itself.

THIS WEEK

Day	Event
Wed	Harbor jazz, 6 p.m., Bandon Pier
Thu	Library story hour, 10 a.m.
Fri	First Friday art walk, downtown
Sat	Lighthouse 170th, low tide 9 a.m.
Sat	Farmers market opens, 9 a.m.
Sun	Tolowa canoe demonstration, 1 p.m.

Submit events to calendar@triplicate.example.

ARTS

County museum reopens marine gallery

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Del Norte County Historical Society reopens its restored marine gallery this weekend, anchored by the second-order Fresnel lens that served Battery Point until its automation in 1953.

The lens, a six-foot beehive of hand-ground glass, was conserved over two years by a volunteer crew. "You can put your face an inch from glass that guided ships for a century," said curator Sefa Adjei.

SCHOOLS

High-school jazz band earns state invitation

By Theo Brennan · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Del Norte High jazz ensemble accepted an invitation to the state festival in Sacramento next month, the first such bid in the program's history. The band will busk at the new farmers market to raise travel funds.

STAGE

Theater company stages 'Our Town' on the lawn

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Lighthouse Repertory Company opens an outdoor production of Thornton Wilder's *Our Town* at the museum lawn next weekend, the troupe's first staging since the pandemic shuttered its small downtown house.

Director Sefa Adjei chose the play deliberately. "It is about an ordinary town that does not know how extraordinary it is until it is gone," he said. "We thought Crescent City could stand to hear that." Performances run Friday and Saturday at dusk; bring a low chair and a blanket against the fog.

LIBRARY

Library summer reading kicks off with a fish tale

The county library's summer reading program opens Saturday with a harbor-themed kickoff: a touch tank from the marine lab, a fish-print art station, and a story hour under a borrowed sail. Sign-ups run all June; prizes include a kayak lesson and a stack of donated paperbacks.

COMMUNITY BRIEFS

Blood drive Tuesday at the fairgrounds, 11 a.m.–4 p.m.
Trail crew volunteers sought for Tolowa Dunes; meet at Kellogg Beach Saturday.
Senior center resumes Friday fish fry June 6.
Quilt guild show and sale at the grange, June 7–8.
Veterans coffee, first Wednesday, American Legion hall.

ADVERTISEMENT

Sea & Redwoods Festival

Three days on the North Coast — June 27–29

Harbor concerts · seafood & chowder · redwood hikes

Tolowa canoe demonstrations · kids' tide-pool tours

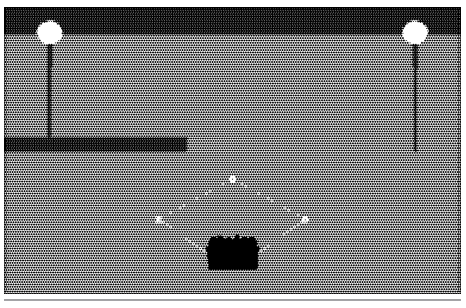
Presented by the Del Norte Chamber of Commerce

Schedule & tickets: searedwoods.example

PREP BASEBALL

Warriors walk off in the ninth, reach league final

A two-out single by Eli Carrera scores Tavita Faleolo and sends Del Norte to Saturday's championship.



Del Norte players mob Eli Carrera at home plate after his walk-off single in the ninth inning Tuesday at Bob Maready Field sent the Warriors to Saturday's league championship game. / Triplicate / J. Okafor

By Theo Brennan · Triplicate Staff Writer

For eight innings Tuesday, the Del Norte Warriors and the visiting Eureka Loggers traded zeros and held their breath. In the ninth, the Warriors finally exhaled.

With two out and the winning run on second, junior Eli Carrera lined a 2–2 pitch into right field, scoring Tavita Faleolo from second base and sending the Warriors to their first league championship game in eleven years. The home crowd poured onto the field at Bob Maready Field before Faleolo had finished his slide.

"I was just looking for something I could put in play," Carrera said, still grinning under a pile of teammates. "I did not even see it land. I heard it."

Starter Mateo Reyes went seven strong innings, scattering five hits and stranding nine Loggers. Coach Dana Whitfield credited the bullpen and a defense that turned two double plays in the late innings. "We have been close all year," Whitfield said. "Tonight close turned into through."

The Warriors (18–6) host the league final Saturday at 1 p.m. A win would be the program's first title since 2015.

PREP SCOREBOARD

Sport	Result
Baseball	Del Norte 3, Eureka 2 (9)
Softball	Del Norte 7, Fortuna 4
Track	DN sweeps coastal relays
Boys golf	Del Norte 2nd at sectionals
Tennis	Fortuna 5, Del Norte 2

Report scores to sports@triplicate.example by 9 p.m.

LEAGUE STANDINGS — BASEBALL

Team	W	L
Del Norte	18	6
Fortuna	16	8
Eureka	15	9
Arcata	11	13
McKinleyville	7	17

PREP SOFTBALL

Softball secures No. 2 seed for playoffs

By Iris Lindqvist · Triplicate Staff Writer

The Warriors' softball team locked up the second seed with a 7–4 win over Fortuna, behind a three-run double from senior Brooke Vandermeer and a complete game from pitcher Sage Lindqvist. Del Norte opens the postseason at home next week.

ON THE WATER

Harbor rows: youth crew launches first season

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

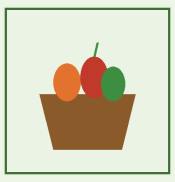
A new youth rowing club put four boats on the inner harbor this spring, sharing the protected water with the crab fleet's idle season. Organizers hope the rebuilt docks will include a dedicated small-craft float. "Flat water and no current — it is a perfect place to learn," said coach Will Abernathy.

FISHING REPORT

Outdoors: spring Chinook open below the dams

The Klamath's spring Chinook fishery opens this weekend, the first since the dam removals. Guides report fish moving past Blue Creek. Check tribal and state regulations before launching.

ADVERTISEMENT



Go, Warriors!

Citizens Dock Market cheers the team on.

Championship-Saturday cookout supplies in stock.

88 Citizens Dock Road · 555-0166

PELICAN BAY

Behind the wall, a classroom rewrites the odds

A College of the Redwoods degree program inside Pelican Bay State Prison graduates its largest cohort yet.

By Iris Lindqvist · Triplicate Staff Writer

On Friday, in a gymnasium ringed by razor wire, nineteen men in borrowed caps and gowns will accept associate degrees earned one careful semester at a time inside Pelican Bay State Prison — the largest cohort since College of the Redwoods brought accredited coursework behind the wall six years ago.

The program is small, oversubscribed and, by every measure the college tracks, working. Participants are dramatically less likely to return to custody after release. "Education is the most reliable key we have ever handed anyone in here," said warden's liaison Captain Dolores Ruiz. "It does not open the gate. It changes who walks through it."

Instructors describe the most motivated students of their careers. "Nobody is here to pad a transcript," said English instructor Tom Achebe, who drives ninety minutes each way to teach composition. "They have read the syllabus twice before I arrive."

The college hopes to add a transferable bachelor's pathway in partnership with a state university, pending funding. For now, nineteen families will watch a livestream on Friday and, for once, the news from Pelican Bay will be good.

SCHOOL NOTES

Last day of classes is June 12; graduation June 13 at the fairgrounds.

Summer meals program runs at three sites; no enrollment required for children 18 and under.

Kindergarten registration open for fall at all elementary sites.

Bus routes for 2026–27 posted at the district office.

WORKFORCE

College of the Redwoods expands marine-trades program

By Theo Brennan · Triplicate Staff Writer

Citing the harbor reconstruction and a graying fleet, College of the Redwoods will double its marine-trades certificate seats this fall, adding welding, marine diesel and small-vessel operations. The harbor district has pledged apprenticeship slots.

"We are building docks and losing deckhands at the same time," said program lead Grace Mbeki. "This is how you fix both."

ELEMENTARY

Smith River school garden feeds the cafeteria

By Maren Holloway · Triplicate Staff Writer

Students at Smith River Elementary harvested the first lettuce and snap peas from a new school garden this week, much of it bound for the cafeteria salad bar. The garden began as a fourth-grade math project on area and perimeter and grew, literally, from there.

COMMUNITY

Scholarships honor late longtime teacher

A new scholarship fund in memory of teacher and coach Raymond Voss will award two $1,500 grants to graduating seniors pursuing trades or the sciences. Applications are open through the counseling office.

IMMERSION

Tolowa language enters the elementary classroom

By Iris Lindqvist · Triplicate Staff Writer

Beginning this fall, kindergartners at two Crescent City elementary schools will start each morning with twenty minutes of Tolowa Dee-ni' — counting, greetings, the names of local plants and animals — taught by apprentice speakers from the Nation's new language program.

The pilot, developed with the Tolowa Dee-ni' Nation, makes Del Norte one of a handful of California districts to bring a Native language into the regular elementary day rather than an after-school elective.

"Children take a language home and teach it to their parents," said program coordinator Della Richmond. "That is how a language comes back — through the youngest mouths in the house."

District officials say they will measure not test scores but attendance and belonging, where early immersion programs elsewhere have shown the clearest gains.

STEM

Robotics team places third at regional meet

The Del Norte High robotics team took third of twenty-six schools at the regional championship in Eureka, its best finish to date, and qualified for the state event. The team is fundraising for travel with a car wash Saturday at the harbor lot.

Obituaries

Harold "Hal" Petersen, 1939–2026

Hal Petersen, who skippered the *Marie Elise* out of Crescent City Harbor for forty-one seasons and never once, he claimed, lost a crab pot he meant to keep, died Sunday at home surrounded by family. He was 86.

Born in Eureka and raised on the water, Hal bought his first boat at 23 and his last at 68. He served two terms on the harbor commission, taught a generation of deckhands to splice line, and could read weather off the western sky better than any instrument aboard. He is survived by his wife of 60 years, Marie; three children; and seven grandchildren who knew him as the man who smelled of diesel and peppermint.

A memorial will be held Saturday at the harbor. In lieu of flowers, the family asks donations to the fishermen's relief fund.

Gloria Whitefeather Sanchez, 1951–2026

Gloria Whitefeather Sanchez, a Tolowa Dee-ni' elder, basket weaver and tireless advocate for the return of the Tolowa language, died peacefully Friday. She was 75.

Gloria learned to weave from her grandmother and spent her last decades teaching the craft — and the language woven into its names — to anyone who would sit still long enough to learn. "She gave the words back," said tribal chair Della Richmond. Services are private; a community gathering will be announced.

Raymond Voss, 1958–2026

Ray Voss taught science and coached track at Del Norte High for thirty-three years. He died Wednesday after a brief illness. Hundreds of his former students are expected at a celebration of life June 14 at the fairgrounds. A scholarship in his name has been established (see Page A9).

Dorothy Ann Kessler, 1934–2026

Dorothy Kessler, who ran the lunch counter at the old Front Street pharmacy for thirty years and never forgot a regular's order, died May 20 at age 91. She is survived by four children, eleven grandchildren and what her family estimates to be three generations of grateful patrons.

James "Jim" Oduya, 1947–2026

Jim Oduya, a millwright at the Smith River plywood mill until its closure and later a beloved Little League umpire, died Thursday. He was 78. "He called them straight and he called them kind," his daughter said. Services pending.

Eleanor "Nell" Brightwater, 1929–2026

Nell Brightwater, who taught third grade at Bess Maxwell Elementary for thirty-six years and was, by the count of a 1998 newspaper profile, the first teacher of roughly a quarter of the town's adults, died peacefully Saturday at 96.

She kept a tide chart and a terrarium at the back of every classroom and believed, she once said, that "a child who can read the tide can read anything." She is survived by two sons, a daughter, and several thousand former students. A celebration of her life will be held at the fairgrounds June 20; in lieu of flowers, the family asks donations to the library.

Robert A. Ferreira, 1944–2026

Bob Ferreira, a Coast Guard veteran, longtime harbor electrician and fixture of the Saturday-morning coffee counter, died at home Friday surrounded by family. He was 81. Memorial arrangements are pending with the family.

SHERIFF'S LOG

Time	Call
6:12a	Elk on 101 near Wilson Creek
9:40a	Welfare check, Front St — OK
1:05p	Minor collision, M & 9th
4:33p	Lost hiker located, Stout Grove
8:51p	Noise complaint, harbor lot
11:20p	Alarm, downtown — false
2:14a	Suspicious vehicle, mill rd
7:02a	Tree down, Howland Hill

Selected calls. A call is not an arrest.

FIRE & MEDICAL CALLS

Type	No.
Medical aid	31
Vehicle accident	4
Structure (minor)	1
Vegetation	2
Public assist	9
Mutual aid	3

Week ending May 23. Crescent Fire Protection Dist.

VITAL RECORDS

Births — To Ana and Luis Moreno, a daughter; to Jess Park and Devon Hall, a son; to Mara and Tom Reilly, twin girls.
Marriage licenses — 4 issued this week at the county clerk.
Court calendar — Superior Court, Dept. 1, civil motions Thursday 9 a.m.; small claims Friday 1:30 p.m.

PROPERTY TRANSFERS

Area	Price
Crescent City	$385,000
Smith River	$298,500
Hiouchi	$210,000
Fort Dick	$455,000
Gasquet	$162,000

Recorded deeds, week of May 18. County Recorder.

Public Notices & Legal

Notice of Lien Sale

Harbor Self-Storage will sell the contents of units 14, 22 and 31 to satisfy liens on June 18 at 10 a.m., 100 Starfish Way. Cash only. The facility reserves the right to refuse bids.

Fictitious Business Name

The following person is doing business as **Foglight Bakery**, 210 Front St: B. Onganga. Filed with the county clerk May 19.

Notice of Public Hearing

The Planning Commission will consider a coastal development permit for a harbor-side café on June 3 at 6 p.m., City Hall. Written comment accepted until noon that day.

Notice to Creditors

Estate of M. Petrov, Case PR-26-041. Creditors must file claims with the court or the personal representative within the statutory period. Dated May 26.

Request for Bids

Del Norte USD invites sealed bids for roof repair at two elementary sites. Mandatory walk-through June 4. Bids due June 18, 2 p.m., district office.

BUILDING PERMITS

Re-roof, 812 Cooper Ave — $14,200.
Deck, 45 Pebble Beach Dr — $9,800.
New SFD, Hiouchi — $312,000.
Tenant improvement, 210 Front St (bakery) — $48,000.
Dock repair, harbor inner basin — see district.

TO PLACE AN AD

Call (707) 555-0179 · 312 H Street · ads@triplicate.example. Line ads $9 / 20 words, 30¢ each add'l word. Deadline noon Monday for Wednesday. Box replies held 30 days.

HELP WANTED

Deckhands — crab/salmon vessel, season start. Exp. pref., will train. Citizens Dock ice house.
Line cook, Foglight Bakery, mornings. Apply 210 Front St.
Marine welder — harbor reconstruction. CR cert. or equiv. (707) 555-0144.
Substitute teachers, Del Norte USD. Sub permit req. District office.
CNA / caregivers, all shifts, Seaside Care. Sign-on bonus.
Diesel mechanic, fleet shop. Heavy equip. exp. Top pay DOE.
Cashier, harbor market, P/T weekends. 18+.
Forest tech, seasonal, Smith River NRA. USAJobs #NC-2026.
Dispatcher, county OES, swing shift. Apply by June 6.
Hotel housekeeping, summer season, will train. (707) 555-0231.

AUTOS & TRUCKS

'19 Tacoma 4x4, 78k, canopy, tow pkg. $28,500. (707) 555-0117.
'12 Subaru Outback, 141k, new tires, runs great. $7,900.
'08 F-250 diesel, flatbed, 210k, strong. $9,500 obo.
Utility trailer, 5x8, ramp gate, lights. $750.
'21 Honda CR-V, 34k, one owner, AWD. $26,200.
Camper shell, fits full-size, white. $300.

FOR SALE

Crab pots, 30, good cond., $25 ea. or $600 all. (707) 555-0188.
Firewood, seasoned tanoak, $280/cord delivered in town.
Kayak, 12-ft sit-on-top, paddle incl., $300. Harbor area.
Woodstove, EPA-cert., $450 obo. You haul. Gasquet.
Chest freezer, 15 cu ft, works. $180.
Generator, 6500W, low hours. $520.
Smoker, vertical, propane, for fish. $120.
Patio set, teak, 6 chairs, weathered but solid. $200.

BOATS & MARINE

32-ft Roughwater, diesel, rigged for crab. Survey avail. Serious only.
Outboard, 9.9 hp 4-stroke, low hours, $1,400.
Slip sublease, inner basin, through Oct. Harbor office approval req.
Crab blocks & line, leaded, 200 fathom. Make offer.
Survival suits, adult, USCG, 2 avail. $250 ea.
14-ft aluminum skiff w/ trailer, 15 hp. $1,950.

RENTALS

2BR cottage, walk to harbor, fenced yard. $1,650/mo + dep. No smoking.
Studio, downtown, utilities incl., $1,050/mo. Avail. June 15.
3BR house, Smith River, garage, pets ok. $2,100/mo.
Room for rent, quiet home, shared bath. $700, utils incl.
RV space, full hookups, monthly. Near beach. $600.
Commercial, Front St storefront, 900 sq ft. Tran Realty.

REAL ESTATE

Land, 5 acres Hiouchi, well + septic. $189,000.
3BR/2BA, ocean view, updated. $429,000. Tran Realty.
Fixer, 2BR near downtown, cash or rehab loan. $215,000.
Timber parcel, 40 ac., road access, off-grid. Inquire.

FARM & RANCH

Hay, grass/orchard mix, no rain, $14/bale. Smith River.
Laying hens, year-old, productive. $12 ea.
Goat, Nigerian dwarf wether, friendly. $90.
Manure, aged, you load, free. Bring truck.

PETS & LIVESTOCK

Lab pups, AKC, black, ready July 4. Dep. holds.
Free barn cats, fixed, great mousers. Fort Dick.
Lost cat, gray tabby, 'Smelt,' harbor area. Reward.

SERVICES

Net mending & gear repair, 40 yrs on the dock. Ask for Pete.
Tree work, licensed/insured. Storm cleanup, fog-belt specialists.
Tax & bookkeeping for small boats and shops. Year-round.
House cleaning, weekly/biweekly, references.
Hauling & dump runs, 1-ton, reasonable.
Welding, mobile, marine & ag. (707) 555-0144.
Childcare, licensed, openings fall. Meals incl.

GARAGE & ESTATE SALES

Sat 8–2, 145 Cooper Ave — tools, marine gear, books.
Multi-family, Sun, Pebble Beach Dr. Kids' stuff, furniture.
Estate, Fri–Sat, antiques, lens glass, ship models.

FREE & WANTED

Free — piano, upright, plays. You move it. South Beach.
Free — moving boxes, clean, lots. Curbside H St.
Wanted — rowers for new youth crew. harbor.row@example.
Wanted — old crab-pot floats for art project. Will trade.
Wanted — used kiln, small, for school. Donations welcome.

LOST & FOUND

Found: ship's bell, brass, Kellogg Beach. Describe to claim.
Lost: orange survival suit, 'REYES' on collar. Reward.
Found: keys w/ float, harbor lot. At Triplicate office.

NOTICES & PERSONALS

Thank you to the stranger who returned my dog at Battery Point. — A grateful keeper.
Reunion: Del Norte High class of '76, Aug. 8, fairgrounds. RSVP Linda.
AA / Al-Anon meets daily, harbor church basement, noon & 7 p.m.
Free meals for seniors, M–F, community center, 11:30 a.m.

SERVICE DIRECTORY

Appliance Repair — North Coast Appliance, (707) 555-0102.
Auto Body — Redwood Collision, free estimates, 555-0119.
Carpet & Floors — Coastal Flooring, 555-0140.
Chimney Sweep — Fog Belt Sweeps, insured, 555-0155.
Concrete — Lindahl & Sons, drives & foundations, 555-0161.
Dentist — Harbor Family Dental, new patients, 555-0173.
Electrician — Tidewater Electric, lic. #C10, 555-0184.
Excavation — Smith River Earthworks, septic, 555-0190.
Fencing — Redwood Fence Co., deer & ranch, 555-0205.
Glass — Crescent Glass, auto & marine, 555-0211.
Heating — North Coast HVAC, heat pumps, 555-0224.
Insurance — Del Norte Mutual, home & boat, 555-0237.
Landscaping — Fern Canyon Gardens, 555-0249.
Locksmith — Battery Point Lock, 24 hr, 555-0252.
Painting — Maritime Painters, int/ext, 555-0268.
Plumbing — Tidewater Plumbing, 24 hr, 555-0271.
Propane — Coast Propane, delivery, 555-0285.
Roofing — Rainshadow Roofing, metal, 555-0298.
Septic Pumping — Clear Creek Septic, 555-0301.
Storage — Harbor Self-Storage, 555-0314.
Surveyor — North Coast Land Surveys, 555-0327.
Towing — 101 Towing, 24 hr, 555-0330.
Tree Service — Old Growth Arbor, lic/ins, 555-0346.
Veterinarian — Redwood Animal Hospital, 555-0359.
Well Drilling — Smith River Well, 555-0362.
Windows — Coastal Window & Door, 555-0378.

WORSHIP DIRECTORY

St. Joseph Catholic — Mass Sun 8 & 10:30 a.m.
First Presbyterian — Worship Sun 10 a.m.
Harbor Community — Sun 9 & 11 a.m., nursery.
Bethany Lutheran — Sun 9:30 a.m.
Crescent Bible — Sun 10:45 a.m., Wed 7 p.m.
United Methodist — Sun 10 a.m., fellowship after.
Seventh-day Adventist — Sat 11 a.m.
Tolowa Dee-ni' Gatherings — call Howonquet center.
Friends Meeting — Sun 10 a.m., silent worship.
Grace Fellowship — Sun 9 & 11 a.m.

PUBLIC & LEGAL NOTICES

NOTICE OF TRUSTEE'S SALE — T.S. No. 26-0142. The property at 88 Pebble Beach Dr. will be sold at public auction June 24, 10 a.m., at the county courthouse steps, to the highest bidder for cash. Amount of unpaid balance and other charges as of first publication: $214,880.16.

NOTICE INVITING BIDS — Harbor District seeks sealed bids for dredging of the inner boat basin. Pre-bid conference June 9. Bids due June 23, 2 p.m. Plans at the district office, 101 Citizens Dock Rd.

SUMMONS — Case CV-26-0188. To the defendant: you have 30 days after service to file a response. Failure may result in default judgment. Clerk of the Superior Court, Del Norte County.

ABANDONED VESSEL — The 28-ft vessel 'Sea Mist,' hull #DN4471, will be deemed abandoned and disposed of after June 30 unless claimed. Harbormaster, (707) 555-0179.

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Honor a loved one in print. Standard obituaries are published as a community service; extended tributes and photographs are available at modest cost. obits@triplicate.example · (707) 555-0166.

CARD OF THANKS

The family of Hal Petersen thanks the harbor community, the relief fund and the crew of the *Marie Elise* for their kindness in our loss. Fair winds, Captain.

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Fresh from the fog.
Order your festival pastry trays now.
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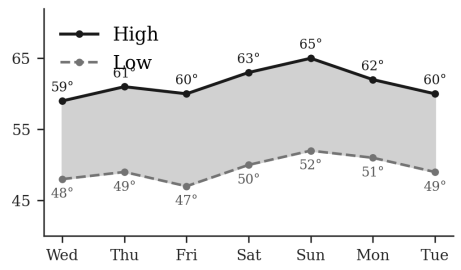
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THE ALMANAC

A week of fog, then a holiday of sun

The marine layer holds through midweek before a building ridge clears the coast for the long weekend.



Seven-day forecast highs and lows for Crescent City. Temperatures climb steadily into the holiday weekend as the marine layer retreats offshore. / **Triplicate / National Weather Service data**

By the Triplicate Weather Desk

A stubborn marine layer will keep Crescent City gray through midweek, with morning drizzle giving way to high overcast and afternoon clearing near the Oregon line. West winds pick up each afternoon, 10 to 15 knots, easing after sunset.

By Friday a building ridge of high pressure nudges the fog offshore. Expect the clearest, warmest stretch since April through the holiday weekend, with inland Hiouchi and Gasquet running ten degrees warmer than the immediate coast.

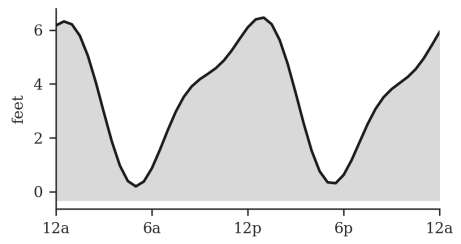
Boaters should note a moderate northwest swell building Saturday — three to five feet at eight seconds — and a small-craft advisory possible outside the harbor by afternoon.

TIDES — CRESCENT CITY HARBOR

Mixed semidiurnal. Heights above MLLW; the second low each day runs deepest.

	High	Low
Wed	6.8 ft 3:42a	-0.6 ft 10:51a
Wed	5.9 ft 5:10p	1.1 ft 10:33p
Thu	6.6 ft 4:28a	-0.4 ft 11:38a
Thu	5.7 ft 6:01p	1.3 ft 11:19p

Battery Point reachable on foot at lows below ~1.5 ft.



A representative 24-hour tide curve for the harbor. The North Coast's mixed semidiurnal pattern brings two unequal highs and two unequal lows each day. / **Triplicate / NOAA data**

SUN & MOON

	Rise	Set
Sun	5:51a	8:38p
Moon	1:12p	1:40a

Moon: waxing gibbous, 78% illuminated. Full moon May 31.

REGIONAL FORECAST

Town	Hi / Lo	Sky
Crescent City	59 / 48	Fog a.m.
Smith River	61 / 47	Fog a.m.
Hiouchi	70 / 46	Sunny
Gasquet	72 / 45	Sunny
Klamath	60 / 48	Cloudy
Brookings, OR	60 / 49	Fog a.m.

Inland valleys run 10–12° warmer than the coast.

MARINE & BAR FORECAST

	Today	Sat
Wind	NW 10–15	NW 15–20
Seas	3–5 ft	5–7 ft
Swell	NW 8 sec	NW 9 sec
Bar	Moderate	Rough p.m.

Small-craft advisory possible Sat. afternoon outside the harbor.

RIVERS & BARS

River	Level	Temp
Smith (Jed)	4.1 ft	54°
Klamath (lower)	6.8 ft	58°
Lake Earl	—	61°

Gauge heights, 6 a.m. Source: USGS.

BY THE NUMBERS

Yesterday — High 58°, Low 49°, at the airport.
Record high May 27 — 79° (1987).
Record low May 27 — 38° (1955).
Rain to date — 71.4 in (season); avg 64.2 in.
Wettest town in California, most years. We have made peace with it.

FROM THE ARCHIVE · 1964

Looking Back: The night the ocean came up Front Street

Sixty-two years ago this spring, the keeper's log at Battery Point recorded, in a steady hand that betrays only a little of the night's terror, the aftermath of the deadliest tsunami in the modern history of the West Coast. On Good Friday, March 27, 1964, at 5:36 in the afternoon Alaska time, the ground beneath Prince William Sound heaved in a magnitude-9.2 earthquake — the second-largest ever recorded — and shoved a train of waves south down the Pacific.

Most of the coast was spared the worst. San Francisco saw a harmless ripple. Crescent City did not.

The reason is written in the seafloor. The continental shelf off Del Norte County and the curve of the coastline conspire to gather tsunami energy and aim it, like a funnel, straight into the mouth of the harbor — then trap it there, where it sloshes and builds. The first wave arrived just before midnight and was modest. So was the second. Some residents who had evacuated came back downtown to check on their shops.

The fourth wave was not modest. It came over the breakwater near one in the morning, a wall of black water that drove inland for three blocks, floated cars into storefronts, ignited a bulk-fuel fire at the tank farm and erased the heart of the business district. When it withdrew it took eleven lives with it.

A town that rebuilt on the same ground

In the gray morning the survivors counted the cost: twenty-nine blocks flattened, the fishing fleet scattered and splintered, the dead being recovered from the mud. There was talk, briefly, of moving the town to higher ground. It did not last. Crescent City rebuilt where it had always been — because it was home, because the harbor was the only reason for a town to exist on that stretch of fogbound coast at all, and because the boats had nowhere else to go.

The rebuild made Crescent City, against its will, the nation's foremost classroom in tsunami survival. The town wired the harbor with instruments. It drilled its schoolchildren until the evacuation routes were muscle memory. When a surge from the 2011 Tōhoku earthquake in Japan crossed the entire Pacific and again tore out the docks, no one in Crescent City died — because by then the town knew, better than anywhere in America, exactly what the ocean was capable of and exactly how many minutes it would grant.

The docks rising in the inner basin this week (see Page A1) are the latest chapter in that long, unfinished argument with the Pacific — the one argument this town has never once had the luxury of walking away from. The new floats are engineered to ride the next wave up their pilings and settle back down. The eleven names from 1964 are not engineered into anything yet. The letters on this page ask that they be carved into the new pier. The argument continues.

COLOPHON

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